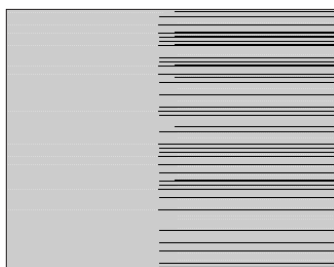


and feel of your blog to suit your style and personality, and add advertising banners and affiliate links that can provide some additional revenue.

Of course, advertising is also possible on paid blog sites. The only difference between hosting your own blog and using a free host is the level of control you have over the look and feel and presentation style.

1.4.2 Photo Blogs

Photo bloggers are the next step in the blogging evolution. With the ubiquity of the digital camera and camera phones, taking pictures has almost become a reflex action. Sites such as Flickr.com and Photobucket.com allow you to host your images for free with basic features, and for a fee with advanced features. You can make your pictures public, keep them private, or share them with select friends.



Flickr Home Page

1.4.3 Personal Portals

What happens when you mash up content blogs with photo blogs? You get sites such as Yahoo 360o (360.yahoo.com), My Space (myspace.com) and Multiply (multiply.com). The premise of these sites is that it is no longer just about text or photos. The digital persona should encompass every aspect of a person's social life, enabling them to publish blogs, photos, videos, music and more, while at the same time connecting them with friends and peers via a seamless interface.



Multiply - One Site for Everything